

English Practice Homework

For: **Gürkan** | Based on Session 3 — March 10, 2026

Teacher: Khan Ahsan Hussain | Due: Before Next Session

Dear Gürkan,

In our last session you spoke confidently for over an hour on technical topics, introduced yourself to a new person, and had a great cultural discussion. You are making excellent progress!

This homework is designed around what **you actually said and struggled with** in the session. Complete all five parts before our next meeting. Remember: *“Learning English is your new hobby!”*

Part 1 — Vocabulary: Pavement Distress Types

In the session you discussed pavement distresses. Match each term with its correct definition.

Exercise A — Match the Term to the Definition

Terms	Definitions
1. Raveling	a. Upward displacement of asphalt due to excess bitumen
2. Bleeding	b. Loss of surface material due to traffic and weather
3. Crocodile Cracking	c. Interconnected cracks forming a pattern like reptile skin
4. Depression	d. Cracks running parallel or perpendicular to the road axis
5. Longitudinal/Transverse Cracking	e. A localized low area in the pavement surface
6. Pothole	f. A bowl-shaped hole caused by progressive surface failure

Your answers: 1.__ 2.__ 3.__ 4.__ 5.__ 6.__

Exercise B — Priority Ranking (Your Opinion)

In the session you said “*Raveling is number one.*” Below are six distress types. Rank them from **1 (most important)** to **6 (least important)** in your opinion, and write **one sentence explaining each choice**.

1. Raveling Rank: ___
Why: _____
2. Bleeding Rank: ___
Why: _____
3. Crocodile Cracking Rank: ___
Why: _____
4. Pothole / Patch Rank: ___
Why: _____
5. Depression Rank: ___
Why: _____
6. Edge Cracking Rank: ___
Why: _____

Part 2 — Grammar Focus: Articles (a / an / the / –)

You said “*We don’t use articles in Turkish.*” — That is exactly right! This is why articles are one of the hardest parts of English for Turkish speakers. Study the rules below and complete the exercises.

Quick Rules:

- Use **a / an** for singular, non-specific nouns (first mention). *e.g., I saw a crack on the road.*
- Use **the** for specific or previously mentioned nouns. *e.g., The crack was very deep.*
- Use **–** (no article) for general plural nouns or uncountable nouns. *e.g., Roads need maintenance.*

Exercise C — Fill in the blank: a / an / the / (nothing)

1. I am ___ civil engineer specializing in pavement.
2. ___ raveling is ___ most common distress on Turkish highways.
3. We always examine ___ right lane because heavy traffic passes there.
4. My company is called GeoPave. ___ company is based in Ankara.
5. ___ photos taken from 1–2 meters height are very useful for detection.
6. She graduated from ___ Istanbul Commerce University.
7. ___ bleeding occurs when there is too much bitumen in ___ surface layer.
8. He is ___ expert in geotechnical engineering.

Part 3 — Speaking Practice: Talking About Yourself

In the session you introduced yourself to Ifrah very well. Now practice doing it in writing so you can speak even more confidently next time.

Exercise D — Write a Short Self-Introduction (80–120 words)

Write a paragraph introducing yourself as if you are meeting someone for the first time. Include:

- Your name and profession
- Your education background (Istanbul Technical University)
- Your company (GeoPave) and what it does
- One hobby (fishing, puzzles, or now — learning English!)
- One personal detail (where you live, your family, etc.)

Part 4 — Modal Verbs: can / could / need to / have to

In the session you used “we need to”, “you can”, and “it is not possible to” correctly — great job! Now let’s practice using all four modal verbs precisely.

Exercise E — Rewrite the sentence using the word in brackets

1. It is not possible to go fishing in Ankara. **[cannot]**

2. It is necessary for us to study the right lane. **[have to]**

3. It is necessary to use photos to detect bleeding. **[need to]**

4. It was possible for them to identify the distress from the photo. **[could]**

5. Is it possible for you to find more experts? **[can]**

Part 5 — Free Writing: Cultural Comparison

Ifrah shared interesting cultural differences between Somalia and Turkey. You also mentioned some observations. This is a great topic to practice fluency.

Exercise F — Write a Short Paragraph (100–150 words)

Prompt: *What is one cultural difference between Turkey and another country (or culture) that you have noticed? Why do you think this difference exists?*

You can write about:

- Questions people ask (age, marriage, job) — as discussed in the session
- Lifestyle, hobbies, food, language
- Work culture (like how you work “around the clock” and manage everything yourself!)

Vocabulary to Study

Study these words and phrases that came up in the session. Write the Turkish meaning next to each one.

English	Turkish Meaning
Distress (road distress)	_____
Bitumen	_____
Raveling	_____
Bleeding	_____
Deterioration	_____
Methodology	_____
Rigorous	_____
Consultancy	_____
Charming	_____
Balance (life balance)	_____

Bonus Challenge (Optional)

Record yourself speaking for **2–3 minutes** on one of these topics and send it to your teacher before next session:

- Explain the difference between raveling and bleeding to someone who knows nothing about roads.
- Describe your company GeoPave: what it does, who works there, and your goals.
- Talk about a hobby you enjoy (fishing, puzzles) and why you like it.

Do not worry about making mistakes — just speak! That is how you improve.

“Day by day, you are getting better and better!” — Keep it up, Gürkan.